

Safe Browsing Practices -- Guided Notes

Unit tp-6.12 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 6.2 | N10-008 FC0-U71 6.2

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Complete each question using the lesson reading. Write in the blank or answer in the space provided.

Question 1

HTTPS (HyperText Transfer Protocol Secure) encrypts communication between the browser and web server using _____. A _____ padlock in the browser address bar indicates an HTTPS connection. HTTPS does NOT mean the website is _____ -- it only means the _____ is encrypted. Phishing sites routinely use HTTPS.

Question 2

A browser warning 'Your connection is not private' means the site's _____ certificate is invalid, expired, or not signed by a trusted _____ Authority. Users should not click 'proceed anyway' on unfamiliar sites because HTTPS protects the _____, not the site's _____.

Question 3

Drive-by downloads occur when visiting a _____ website causes malware to be automatically _____ without user interaction. They often exploit unpatched vulnerabilities in the _____ or _____. Keeping both updated and enabling _____ -scripting defenses (blocking unknown JavaScript) reduces risk.

Question 4

URL inspection before clicking: check that the _____ domain is the expected one (attackers use similar-looking domains like paypa1.com). Look for _____ (misspellings designed to look like legitimate domains). Hover over links before clicking to see the _____ URL in the status bar. Shortened URLs (bit.ly) can _____ the real destination.

Question 5

Browser extensions can be a significant _____ risk. A malicious extension can read and modify _____ on pages visited, steal _____, and bypass _____ controls. Best practice: install only extensions from _____ sources with a high number of verified reviews, and remove unused extensions.

Question 6

Cookies are small files websites store in the browser to remember _____ and preferences. Third-party _____ track users across websites for advertising. _____ mode (Incognito) prevents local storage of browsing history and reduces some tracking but does NOT make browsing _____ from the network or websites.

Question 7

An ad blocker can reduce _____ ad attacks (malicious ads that deliver malware). A DNS _____ service (like Cloudflare 1.1.1.1 with filtering or OpenDNS) blocks requests to known _____ domains before they load. A Web proxy or _____ Filter categorizes and blocks unsafe websites at the network level.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A student clicks a link in a Discord message that says 'free Steam games.' The link opens a page that looks identical to the Steam login page, but the URL is 'stearn.io' instead of 'store.steampowered.com'. They enter their username and password. Two hours later their Steam account is emptied of \$300 in items. Explain what attack occurred and list four specific warning signs the student should have caught.

Download the answer key from the class server:

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wget http://[SERVER]/resources/network-engineer/tp-6-12-safe-browsing-practices/tp-6-12-safe-browsing-practices-answer-key.pdf
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